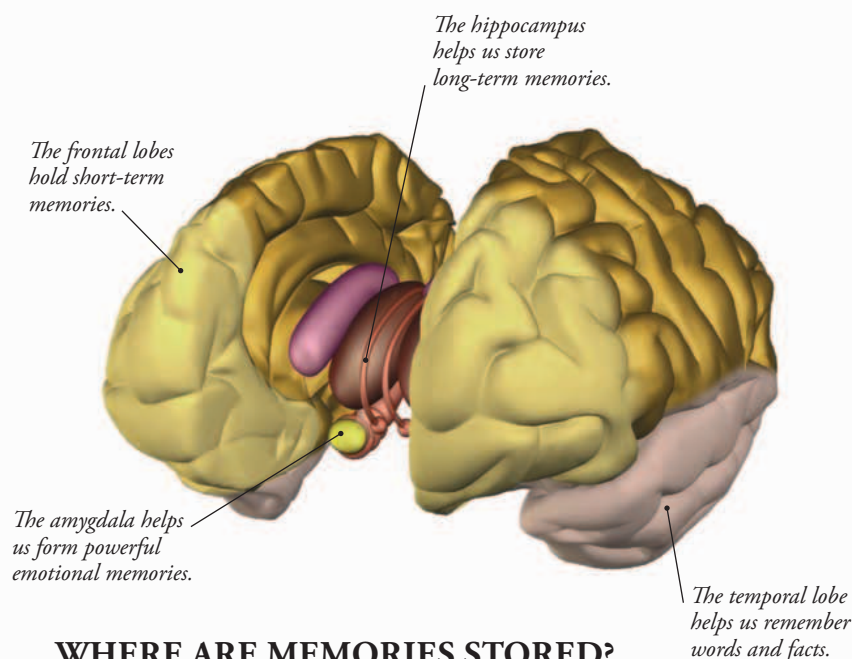


# How memory works

The human brain is always gathering information and storing it for future use, but not everything we learn or experience is easy to remember. Some memories last only seconds and are meant to be forgotten. Others leave a permanent stamp on our brains.



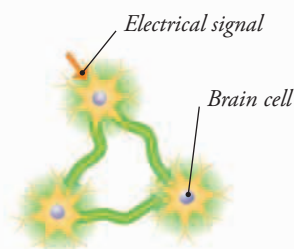
## WHERE ARE MEMORIES STORED?

Memories aren't stored in one place in the brain. Instead, they're spread out across the whole brain, and a single memory can involve several parts of the brain. The areas most important in storing memories are the temporal lobe and the hippocampus.



## MAKING MEMORIES

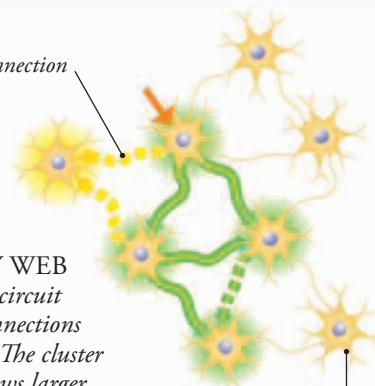
Your brain stores memories and other kinds of information as networks of connections between brain cells. Every experience you have causes your brain cells to fire (send electrical signals) in a specific pattern. When you remember something, you trigger the same network of neurons that originally fired. Each time you use the memory, the connections are strengthened and the memory becomes easier to recall.



### 1. LINKS FORM

*An experience causes a brain cell to send signals to other cells, forming a network of connections.*

*New connection*



### 2. MEMORY WEB

*Each time the circuit is used, the connections grow stronger. The cluster of cells also grows larger, making the memory easier to access.*

*More cells join the circuit*